



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Berkeley Preparatory School
School Website: <https://www.berkeleyprep.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org)****Executive Summary**

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (ACS) publicly presents a robust, coherent classical Christian philosophy and program: it explicitly frames education as the cultivation of wisdom and virtue ordered to the contemplation of truth, goodness, and beauty; centers its curriculum on the Trivium with Latin and rhetoric; employs memorization/recitation in the Grammar years, debate/discussion and explicit Socratic method in upper grades, and culminates in capstone rhetoric defenses; integrates theological study across the curriculum and begins each on-campus day with Chapel; and structures a collaborative model that actively partners with and forms parents. On balance, ACS aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework and the classicality lexicon across all six categories, with only minor gaps (e.g., little explicit use of the term *scholé* and limited evidence of a formal “portrait of a teacher/student”).

School website audited: <https://austinclassical.org>

Note on method: Keywords and phrases were matched against the Positive/Negative indicators from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classicality lexicon, then quantified by category to justify each rating.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — Rating: CLASSICAL

- Evidence from ACS (site keywords/phrases):
- “glorify Jesus Christ”; “classical, Christian education” (mission)
- Aim: “cultivate wisdom and virtue”; method: contemplation of “the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”
- “interrelatedness of all knowledge under the sovereignty of God through theology”
- Christian Studies courses: “Exegesis & Hermeneutics,” “Development of Christian Doctrine,” “Apologetics & Ethics”
- “begin each on-campus instructional day with Chapel” (communal worship)
- Lexicon comparison and analysis:
- Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue; theology; sacred scripture/doctrine; chapel/worship (liturgical practices). These directly align with the framework’s Religious/Metaphysical positives and liturgical practices list.
- Negative indicators (values-neutral, secular, relativism) absent.
- Quantification:

- Positive keyword hits: +10 (truth/goodness/beauty, wisdom, virtue, theology integration, Christian Studies, chapel, prayer/worship language)
 - Negative keyword hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00 (100%)
 - Coverage of sub-elements (moral realism; theology; liturgical/communal): 1.00 (100%)
 - Justification: Clear and explicit Christian theological grounding with liturgical life and transcendental moral realism.
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — Rating: CLASSICAL

- Evidence from ACS:
 - Aim: “cultivate wisdom and virtue” and contemplation of “the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (formation, not mere information)
 - “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”
 - “not ... a traditional college preparatory institution ... our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life”
 - Lexicon comparison:
 - Matches positives: formation, wisdom, virtue, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful over careerism.
 - Negatives (college-and-career-readiness jargon as primary aim) are explicitly rejected.
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: +6
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage of sub-elements (virtue/wisdom, T/G/B, formation not information): 1.00
 - Justification: ACS distinctly frames telos as wisdom/virtue and directs aims toward enduring truths.
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — Rating: CLASSICAL

- Evidence from ACS:
- Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) articulated and implemented school-wide
- Latin from 5th grade through Latin IV; formal Logic; Rhetoric coursework; Senior Thesis with oral defense
- Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis (explicit)
- History labeled and taught as “History” (not Social Studies); sequence from Ancient to Modern/US context
- Integrated approach linking disciplines under theology (integration language present)
- Lexicon comparison:

- Matches positives: “Trivium,” “Latin,” “Great Books,” “Great Conversation,” “History,” primary sources (noted in School Profile), integrated approach.
 - Negatives (social studies framing supplanting history, STEM-first/program dominance, project-based dominance) not present.
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: +9
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (Trivium; History as history; Great Books; Wonder): 0.75 (no explicit use of the term “wonder,” though curiosity/contemplation are present)
 - Justification: Clear liberal-arts core with Latin and rhetoric; Great Books/primary sources; coherent historical and integrated curriculum.
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY / TEACHING METHODS — Rating: CLASSICAL

- Evidence from ACS:
 - Grammar school pedagogy: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (chanting/singing equivalents)
 - Logic stage: “debate and discussion” (dialectic emphasis)
 - Explicit: “we employ the Socratic method in our classrooms” (upper levels)
 - Rhetoric stage: senior thesis, written/oral defense before panel (capstone oration)
 - Contemplation language: method centers on contemplation of the true/good/beautiful (restful orientation, though not using the keyword *scholé*)
 - Lexicon comparison:
 - Matches positives: Socratic/dialectic; recitation/memorization/songs; rhetorical oration/defense; contemplation.
 - Negatives (project-based-only, student-directed, constructivist dominance) not indicated.
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: +8
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (Socratic; restful/*scholé*; chanting/recitation; rhetoric orations): 0.80 (no explicit term “*scholé*,” but contemplative language is present)
 - Justification: Classical pedagogy articulated and practiced across stages with strong evidence.
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY — Rating: CLASSICAL

- Evidence from ACS:
- Teachers are professed Christians, expected to “model proper behavior,” maintain order, and “form the souls of our children” (moral exemplars)

- Teachers provide curriculum and direction to co-teachers; are trained/observed; ongoing formation for consistency (faculty formation)
 - Daily Chapel with students/teachers together (common liturgical life)
 - Lexicon comparison:
 - Matches positives: models of virtue; mentorship/formation language; teacher formation. While “portrait of a teacher/student” wording is not explicitly published, the core elements are present.
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: +5
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (models of virtue; mentorship/collegiality; “living curriculum”; explicit portrait statements): 0.50 (no formal “portrait” statements found)
 - Justification: Strong formation/virtue modeling and teacher development; a published “Portrait of a Teacher/Graduate” would strengthen explicitness.
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS & COMMUNITY — Rating: CLASSICAL

- Evidence from ACS:
 - Mission centered on “co-laboring with families” (parent partnership)
 - Collaborative model with “co-teaching parents” and clear teacher-parent roles and communication; parent covenant expectations implicit in model
 - Parent formation resources: recommended classical reading list; podcast “Portrait of a Graduate” shared for parents to consider “the ultimate aim of education”
 - Community events: Recitatio, athletics/theater attendance, tours/information meetings, and “Grand Mustangs Club” for grandparents (intergenerational engagement)
 - Lexicon comparison:
 - Matches positives: partnership with parents/co-teachers; parent formation; intentional community events.
 - Negative (consumer framing; minimal parent involvement) absent.
 - Quantification:
 - Positive hits: +5
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (partnership; parent education; open/hospitable campus): 0.67 (parent visits are offered via tours; “open anytime” not stated)
 - Justification: Strong, structural partnership with robust parent/community formation.
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Aggregate Rating: **CLASSICAL**

ACS meets or exceeds the positive indicators in all six elements and avoids negative signals. Its theological grounding, Trivium-centered curriculum (Latin/logic/rhetoric), explicit Socratic/recitation pedagogy, senior thesis/defense, faculty formation as moral exemplars, and genuine parent partnership embody the classical model. Minor growth edges are largely about publishing more explicit statements using classical terms (e.g., “scholé,” “portrait of a teacher/graduate”) rather than substantive programmatic gaps.

Evidence Appendix: Selected Site Excerpts

- Truth/Goodness/Beauty, wisdom/virtue aim; Trivium; Great Books/Conversation; contemplation: ACS Classical Education Basics
 - Trivium stages; songs/recitation (Grammar); debate/discussion (Logic); rhetoric/thesis defense (Rhetoric)
 - Socratic method employed in classrooms (upper levels)
 - Theology integration; Christian Studies courses; Chapel daily
 - Parent partnership/co-teacher model; parent formation resources; community events
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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